

COBOTS And AUGMENTED REALITY Changing The World



Vinayak Ramachandra Adkoli is BE in industrial production. He was lecturer in mechanical department for 10 years in three different polytechnics. Now, he is a freelance writer and cartoonist



Aethon TUG cobot automates delivery and material movement in hospitals (Credit: Business Wire)

In this article, we discuss cobots and AR from the perspective of motivation, technology and business, while adding a social spin to these

Cobots (or collaborative robots) and augmented reality (AR) are advancing societal development. Cobots are finding use in sectors like manufacturing and medical for detecting errors and increasing productivity and, hence, motivating entrepreneurs to actively use these technologies.

When robots flooded the manufacturing sector, cobots came to the rescue. AR projects were established, which further enhanced and eased manufacturing. Even as robots demonstrated timely use of tech infrastructure, cobots eliminated the drawbacks of robots.

There are several examples of how cobots and AR have come to the aid of society in times of need. Developed in difficult times, today these are the silent tech heroes of the world. Cobots have received celebrity status, while AR is doing its job

quietly to benefit society. Some companies/technologists develop these solutions as a part of their corporate social responsibility (CSR) initiatives, while others do it for personal satisfaction. Then, there are entrepreneurs who manage to implement such socially-beneficial solutions with a profitable business plan—although, this calls for a fine balancing of reach and pricing.

In this article, we scan through such technological solutions from the perspective of motivation, technology and business, while adding a social spin to these.

Cobots and AR are new platforms to connect technology and society

Cobots are essentially cooperative robots, intended to physically interact with humans in a shared work space. These were invented by J. Edward Colgate and Michael Peshkin, both professors at North-